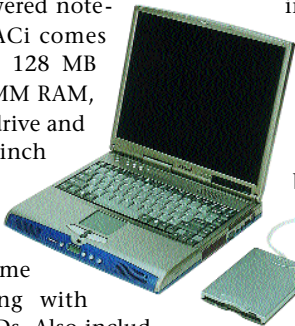


ACi Emerald

Mobile powerhouse!

This Pentium 4-M 2.0 GHz powered notebook from ACi comes packed with 128 MB DDR SO-DIMM RAM, 20 GB hard drive and a crisp 14.1-inch TFT screen. It comes with Windows XP Home Edition along with the driver CDs. Also included is a leather carry bag and an external USB floppy drive, which felt out of place in an otherwise compact notebook. It is fairly robust and the Lithium Ion battery ran for around 102 minutes in the BatteryMark 4.01 test. In Content Creation 2001, it scored a low 37.9, a score that could've been bettered by about 25 per cent if it had 256 KB of cache memory. A memory of 256 MB also becomes a necessity to run Windows XP



Home Edition smoothly. The integrated SiS 650 graphics chip with shared memory architecture of 64 MB supports a resolution of 1024x768 with 32-bit colour depth. We ran a VCD on it and there was no noticeable blur in the display and the speaker sub-system was pretty decent too. It can double up as an entertainment companion since it bundles a full duplex soundcard along with an RCA TV Out port.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium 4 processor, 128 MB DDR RAM, 20 GB hard disk, CD-ROM drive, USB floppy drive, SiS 650 graphics with shared memory up to 64 MB, one PCMCIA slot, four USB ports, one PS/2 port, one IEEE 1394 FireWire port, onboard 56K modem, onboard LAN

Price: Rs 89,990 + taxes
Contact: Allied Computer International (Asia) Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 022-6366800
Fax: 022-6366356
E-mail: sales@aci-asia.com
Web site: www.aci-asia.com

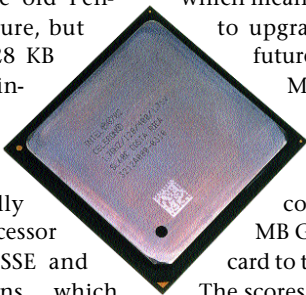
ACi Emerald

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Intel Celeron 1.7 GHz

Old P4 in Celeron clothing

The new Celeron 1.7 GHz is based on the old Pentium 4 architecture, but features only 128 KB of L2 cache, hindering the exploitation of its full potential. Thankfully though, the processor features MMX, SSE and SSE2 instructions, which assist in multimedia applications and gaming. Even though it uses the older 0.18 micron manufacturing technology, it uses the new Socket 478 interface, allowing it to be used on the same boards as



the Northwood Pentium 4, which means you will be able to upgrade easily in the future. We used a 256 MB DDR SDRAM with an Intel D 8 4 5 G B V motherboard coupled with a 64 MB GeForce3 graphics card to test the processor. The scores were disappointing: the processor could not keep up with the GeForce3, severely bottlenecking the gaming and multimedia benchmarks. This was most apparent in the *Quake III Arena* test where the average

frame rates in Normal, High and Maximum modes were a playable but not too impressive at 74.2, 74.5 and 68 fps respectively. In the FPU-intensive POV-Ray test, the Celeron 1.7 GHz took a staggeringly long time of 6 minutes 43 seconds.

The new Intel Celeron is not recommended if you are heavily into 3D gaming and

professional 3D applications, but will be satisfactory for your day-to-day office applications and for running general desktop software that aren't too taxing on the processor.

SPECIFICATIONS

1.7 GHz clock speed; 128 KB L2 cache; Socket 478 interface; Willamette core (0.18 micron)

Intel Celeron 1.7 GHz	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 5,925

Contact: Nebula Technologies

Phone: 022-6730567

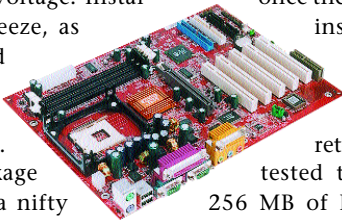
E-mail: sandip@nebulatech.com

Web site: www.intel.com

MSI 845E Max2-BLR motherboard

MSI to the max

This motherboard packs in a number of features including a plethora of over-clocking options such as FSB adjustments up to 233 MHz, AGP over voltage and DDR SDRAM over voltage. Installation is a breeze, as the board sports no jumpers or dipswitches. The MSI package also features a nifty utility called Fuzzy Logic4, which takes complete control of the overclocking process and finds the safe limits for a successful overclock. It is further packed with six USB ports, D-LEDs (Diagnostic LEDs), onboard LAN, onboard six-channel audio, onboard RAID (0+1), USB 2.0 functionality and a rock solid 845E chipset implementation. Sporting an unconventional blood red colour, the special heat sinks mounted on the MOSFETs (Metal Oxide Semiconductor Field Effect Trans-



istor) makes this board stand out among the rest. The only problem is the placement of the AGP slot and the DIMM slots; you won't be able to add or remove any RAM modules once the graphics card is installed since the AGP card will block the DIMM slot retention clips. We tested the board with 256 MB of DDR SDRAM, a Pentium 4 2.53 GHz processor coupled with a GeForce3 graphics card. The scores almost matched up with our RDRAM-powered test machine using the same processor. It scored an impressive 7381 in 3DMark2001SE and 162.6 fps in *Quake III Arena* at maximum settings.

SPECIFICATIONS

845E chipset; Socket 478 processor interface; support for 266 MHz DDR SDRAM; integrated six-channel audio, RAID (0+1) controller and USB 2.0

Price: Rs 10,000

Company: Priya Ltd

Phone: 022-2663611

E-mail: salesbom@priyagroup.com

Web site: www.msi.com.tw

MSI 845E Max2-BLR	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶